

Founding Software Engineer

AgentMail (YC S25)

Location: San Francisco, CA

Type: Full-time

Team Size: 3 (Early-stage founding team)

Batch: Y Combinator Summer 2025

About AgentMail

AgentMail is rebuilding email infrastructure from the ground up for the age of AI agents. We're the first API-first email provider designed specifically for AI agents, enabling them to act as first-class citizens on the internet with their own email identities.

Just as Gmail revolutionized email for humans, AgentMail is building the email provider for AI agents. Our platform gives agents their own email inboxes, allowing them to seamlessly integrate with third-party applications, authenticate themselves, and operate at scale—all without the limitations of legacy providers like Gmail and Outlook.

Backed by: Y Combinator

Stage: Early (Summer 2025 batch, currently 3-person team)

The Opportunity

This is a rare opportunity to join as one of the first engineers at a YC-backed company that's defining an entirely new category of infrastructure. You'll be building the foundational technology that powers email communication for AI agents worldwide.

You won't just be writing code—you'll be:

- Architecting core systems from scratch
 - Making critical technical decisions that will shape the product for years
 - Working directly with the founders on product direction and company strategy
 - Building infrastructure that needs to handle millions of emails at scale
 - Defining engineering culture and practices for the team as we grow
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What We're Building

Core Product:

- API and SDK for creating and managing email inboxes for AI agents
- Real-time email sending and receiving infrastructure at scale
- Email parsing and structuring (HTML bodies, attachments)
- Custom domain support for agent email identities
- Built-in SPF, DKIM, and DMARC support for deliverability
- Integration with popular AI frameworks (LangChain, LlamaIndex, CrewAI)

Key Differentiators:

- **Unlimited scalability:** Create thousands of agent inboxes instantly with usage-based pricing
 - **Agent-first design:** No MFA or OAuth complications—agents get their own identities
 - **Developer experience:** Simple, well-documented API designed for AI systems
 - **High availability:** Fault-tolerant global email delivery infrastructure
 - **Built for agents:** Handle the volume and patterns of AI agent email traffic
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Technical Challenges You'll Solve

Email Infrastructure at Scale

- Build a distributed email delivery system capable of handling millions of emails daily
- Design fault-tolerant architecture with high availability guarantees
- Implement SPF, DKIM, and DMARC authentication and validation
- Optimize for both latency and throughput in email processing

Developer Platform

- Design and implement intuitive REST APIs that developers love
- Build SDKs in multiple languages (Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, and more)
- Create real-time webhook systems for email events
- Develop comprehensive API documentation and developer tools

AI Agent Integration

- Build seamless integrations with popular AI frameworks

- Design systems that handle agent-specific email patterns and volumes
- Implement intelligent email parsing for structured data extraction
- Create tools for agents to authenticate with third-party services via email

Security & Deliverability

- Implement robust email authentication and anti-spam measures
- Build reputation management systems for high deliverability rates
- Design security measures to prevent abuse and ensure compliance
- Create monitoring systems for email delivery and inbox health

Data & Parsing

- Build sophisticated email parsing engines for HTML, attachments, and structured data
 - Implement efficient storage and retrieval systems for email content
 - Design systems for email threading, filtering, and organization
 - Create tools for extracting actionable data from email communications
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What You'll Do

- Own and architect major features and infrastructure components from day one
 - Work directly with the founding team on product roadmap and technical decisions
 - Build and scale core email infrastructure systems
 - Implement critical improvements to scalability, reliability, and developer experience
 - Shape the technical vision and architecture of the company
 - Help establish engineering best practices and code standards as we grow
 - Take ownership of major product areas or infrastructure domains
 - Engage with customers to understand their use cases and incorporate feedback
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Required Qualifications

Technical Excellence

- **3+ years of professional software engineering experience** (or equivalent demonstrated ability)

- Strong proficiency in at least one backend language (Python, Go, TypeScript/Node.js, Rust, etc.)
- Experience building and scaling APIs and distributed systems
- Understanding of email protocols (SMTP, IMAP, POP3) and infrastructure is a plus
- Solid computer science fundamentals (algorithms, data structures, system design)

Startup DNA

- Self-starter who thrives in ambiguous, fast-moving environments
- Comfortable wearing multiple hats and context-switching
- Strong product sense and user empathy
- Track record of shipping products quickly and iterating based on feedback
- Ability to make pragmatic technical decisions that balance speed and quality

Technical Depth (Bonus)

- Experience with email infrastructure or deliverability systems
 - Background in AI/ML systems or agent frameworks
 - Previous experience at early-stage startups (especially YC companies)
 - Contributions to open-source projects
 - Experience building developer tools or platforms
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Ideal Candidate Profile

You might be a great fit if you:

- **Love building infrastructure:** You get excited about designing systems that enable others to build amazing products
- **Move fast:** You ship features quickly, iterate based on feedback, and aren't afraid to break things
- **Think like a founder:** You take ownership, make decisions with limited information, and care deeply about the business
- **Are customer-obsessed:** You want to talk to users, understand their problems, and build solutions they love
- **Want to be at a startup:** You're excited about the intensity, ownership, and potential upside of an early-stage company
- **Have technical depth:** You can go deep on hard problems and design elegant solutions to complex challenges

- **Value velocity:** You believe in shipping imperfect solutions and learning, rather than endless planning
 - **Are a force multiplier:** You make everyone around you better through collaboration, communication, and technical excellence
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Technologies We Use

Current Stack (subject to change as we grow):

- Backend: Python, TypeScript/Node.js
- Email Infrastructure: SMTP, IMAP, SPF, DKIM, DMARC
- APIs: REST, WebSockets for real-time events
- AI Integrations: LangChain, LlamaIndex, CrewAI
- Cloud Infrastructure: (Likely AWS/GCP for email delivery)
- Databases: (Likely PostgreSQL, Redis for caching)

Note: As a founding engineer, you'll have significant influence over our technical choices and architecture.

What We Offer

Compensation

- **Competitive salary** for an early-stage startup
- **Significant equity stake** (you're joining as one of the first employees)
- Potential for life-changing financial outcomes if we succeed

Work Environment

- Work directly with the founding team during YC batch
- Be in San Francisco with the team during YC batch
- Collaborate with other YC founders and access to the YC network
- High autonomy and ownership over your work
- Fast feedback loops and rapid iteration cycles

Growth & Impact

- Massive learning opportunity working on novel infrastructure problems
- Define the engineering culture and practices as we scale

- Potential path to engineering leadership or CTO as the company grows
- Build technology that will power the next generation of AI agents
- Work on a product that developers love and actively use

Benefits

- Health, dental, and vision insurance
 - Flexible PTO policy
 - Latest hardware and tools you need to be productive
 - Team offsites and bonding activities
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Our Team

We're a technical founding team with complementary skills in systems engineering, finance/business, and product development. We move quickly, build in public, and are deeply committed to creating infrastructure that enables the next generation of AI applications.

The Vision

Email is the universal interface for the internet. It's how we:

- Authenticate with services
- Receive notifications
- Conduct business communications
- Verify our identity
- Integrate with third-party tools

AI agents need these same capabilities to operate autonomously and effectively. But legacy email providers weren't built for agents—they're built for humans with completely different usage patterns.

AgentMail is building the email infrastructure that makes AI agents first-class citizens of the internet. We're enabling agents to:

- Seamlessly integrate with any email-based service
- Scale from one inbox to millions without friction
- Maintain their own persistent identities
- Operate reliably at machine speed and scale

This is fundamental infrastructure for the AI age. If you want to work on hard technical problems with massive potential impact, this is the opportunity.

AgentMail is an equal opportunity employer. We celebrate diversity and are committed to creating an inclusive environment for all employees.